

François Mansart and Jules Hardouin-Mansart

Henry IV's entry into Paris in 1594 as king of France heralded a period of political and social aspiration. Architecture reflected this, with the bourgeoisie commissioning country houses – *châteaux* – and town mansions, or *hôtels*. By the mid-17th century, the baroque style had found expression in the form of palaces, first in France with the Château de Maisons (opposite, 1651) near Paris, built by François Mansart (1598–1666), and later across Europe. Most of Mansart's patrons were those who had prospered in the service of the crown. His buildings are elegant and harmonious, as can be seen in his Château de Blois (1635–8); his extensive use of a four-sided, double-slope roof, with dormer windows, lent its name to the mansard roof.

Adopting his grand-uncle and teacher's surname, Jules Hardouin-Mansart (1646–1708) served as Louis XIV's chief architect. He enlarged the royal château of Saint-Germain-en-Laye, and from 1675 added extensions to Versailles, including the Grand Trianon, the Orangerie and the fifth chapel.

